EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 8 OCTOBER 2026

South Land Park, Sacramento

South Land Park sits behind the Sacramento River levee, but its winter danger is a healthy tree coming out of waterlogged ground and the outage that follows. The most important step is to reach the 512 Medicare beneficiaries in this ZIP who depend on powered medical equipment before December. That is the highest concentration in this part of the city.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Sacramento County, CA (inferred)	None published for the US, California, or the county	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Wind on saturated soil: windthrown trees and multi-day SMUD outages; river levee is low-probability, high-consequence

13/13 recommendations checked. 0 confirmed as written, 10 corrected, 2 unverified, 1 contraindicated: clearing riverside camps before or during storm warnings. The funding placements were checked separately. None was contraindicated, but the motel-surge line is conditional on the County accepting outside money for rooms, and one placement's cost basis was replaced. **The funding target held at $215k.** If the motel route is closed, only $115k can be committed now. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, California, or Sacramento County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here. Research limit: the web-search quota ran out partway through

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



38.52°N 121.51°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** The winter danger is a healthy tree coming out of waterlogged ground and the outage that follows; the river levee is low-probability, high-consequence.
- **First action.** Sacramento County Public Health, SMUD, and Resources for Independent Living reach the 512 residents on powered medical equipment, enrol them in SMUD's medical rate, and lend power stations by 1 December.*
- **The money.** $150k floor, $215k target, about $350k ceiling; the floor pays for 100 motel rooms over 10 storm nights and $50k of Loaves & Fishes outreach.
- **Do not.** Do not sweep the riverside and Miller Park camps before storms.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

verification, so several checks were made by fetching primary pages directly, and some could not be made at all. They are marked.

Read this first: plan for the trees and the outage, and treat the levee as the rare case. In the most damaging storm series in SMUD's history (December 2022 – January 2023), the urban levees held. People in Sacramento County died under trees on their tents, and South Land Park homes were still dark three days later, with residents using lanterns and fireplaces. Most of the roughly 1,500 trees that fell across the city were “healthy, defect-free,” and more than 1,000 were on private property. The people most exposed here are not visible in the death record: 512 Medicare beneficiaries in ZIP 95822 rely on electricity-dependent equipment (5.6%, against 4.9% county-wide and 3.3% in neighbouring 95818), including 103 on dialysis and 97 on oxygen. Their deaths on day three of an outage would be counted as heart and lung deaths, not storm deaths.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. One rule underlies every action: trigger on individual wind and atmospheric-river forecasts, not on the season. The strong 2015–16 El Niño did not bring Sacramento's flood year, and the most damaging recent storms came in a La Niña winter.

1. Reach the 512 residents on powered medical equipment, enrol them in SMUD's medical rate, and lend batteries that work in a storm outage

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento County Public Health (emPOWER named list); SMUD (MED enrolment); Resources for Independent Living (power stations); dialysis units	MED forms in October (they go by mail); power stations by 1 Dec	~$50k for 50 power stations (see funding); outreach is staff and volunteer time	Deaths from failed oxygen concentrators and home equipment, and from missed dialysis, during multi-day outages

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

HHS emPOWER, re-queried by the verifier on 8 October 2026: ZIP 95822 has 9,116 Medicare beneficiaries, of whom 512 use electricity-dependent equipment, 103 are on in-facility dialysis, and 97 use oxygen. SMUD's Medical Equipment Discount (MED) rate is $15/month. It needs a mailed form signed by a health professional, and it enrols the customer automatically in SMUD's Vulnerable Population Program, which gives extra notice before planned and wildfire outages. Nothing covers an unplanned storm outage. SMUD's battery incentive requires rooftop solar and its Solar and Storage Rate and excludes MED customers, so it is no route for a renter on oxygen. The action: ask County Public Health to request the named emPOWER file, start MED forms now because they are slow, lend power stations of about 2 kWh, and ask dialysis units to move sessions earlier before each forecast storm.*

Corrections: the claim that SMUD shares its MED list with County OES is unverified and has been dropped. SMUD's battery incentive is now up to $6,000 (it was up to $10,000 for projects submitted by 22 September), and the MED exclusion applies to its My Energy Optimizer Partner+ programme. Evidence: early dialysis before Hurricane Sandy was associated with lower 30-day mortality (Lurie et al., *AJKD* 2015, 66:507–512; OR 0.72, 95% CI 0.52–0.997; observational, upper bound near 1). That evidence comes from a hurricane, not an atmospheric river. ZIP 95822 also covers Hollywood Park, Golf Course Terrace, and the Freeport corridor, which are poorer than South Land Park; the 512 are not all in the neighbourhood.

2. On each wind or atmospheric-river warning, offer people camped by the river a confirmed motel or respite bed the day before, with their gear, and pause clearances while the warning lasts

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
County-contracted navigators (motel referrals); First Step Communities (County respite operator); Sacramento Loaves & Fishes outreach	**Protocol written by 1 Nov; runs on every warning to 1 Mar**	**$50k outreach and gear; motel surge conditional (see funding)**	**Tree-on-tent deaths and people caught on low banks in rising water**

The County's own recap of one activation is the strongest local evidence available. Its warming centres held 0–13 guests a night, while motels held 153 in every period, and the County called motels “the most effective and targeted response.” Motels work partly because people can bring partners, pets, and possessions. Motel places come only through navigators (there is no self-referral), and the County

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says capacity “depends on room availability.” The City already opens respite on wind advisories and warnings and on two or more days of 60% rain. Miller Park Safe Ground, at the river edge of this neighbourhood, had to halt operations in the 2023 storms. It reopened by February 2026 with 15 trailers for three guests each, replacing tents.*

Corrections: the “~100 rooms a night cap” was not found in current County material; the County says every available room is used. The two January 2023 tree deaths were on N. 5th St and in North Highlands, not in South Land Park. Unverified, because the search quota ran out: documented encampments along the river by South Land Park, and the status of any move of the Safe Ground site to Roseville Road.

3. Build a storm check-in roster for older residents living alone, with Sacramento Manor's 260 senior units as one anchor

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
South Land Park Neighborhood Association block volunteers (unconfirmed); Sacramento Manor property management; dialysis and home-health providers	**Roster and phone list by 15 Nov**	**Volunteer time; laminated door cards**	**Undetected falls, dead devices, cold homes, and CO exposure on day two or three of an outage**

From the 2020–24 ACS for ZCTA 95822 (46,569 people), checked by the verifier: 7,811 residents are aged 65 or over and 2,180 live alone. Give each enrolled resident a door card with a named buddy's number, and call on day one of any outage longer than 24 hours. Volunteers should knock after the wind drops, not during it. The mortality case comes from the 2003 New York blackout, when non-accidental deaths rose 25% (95% CI 12–41%), about 90 excess deaths (Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012). That was a summer blackout, so the transfer to a winter outage is partial.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: Sacramento Manor (7300 24th St Bypass; 260 single-storey units for residents aged 55 and over, built 1961) is in the Golf Course Terrace/Meadowview area south of Florin Rd, within ZIP 95822 but outside South Land Park. It appears to be income-restricted rather than project-based Section 8. The South Land Park Neighborhood Association's meetings at Belle Cooledge Library could not be verified before the search quota ran out, so confirm it will run a roster before relying on it.

4. Install carbon-monoxide alarms door to door, and tell every household: no generator, grill, or gas oven indoors

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Resources for Independent Living and block volunteers; SMUD and PG&E bill inserts	Before the first atmospheric river; message out by 1 Nov	$15k (see funding)	CO deaths from fuel-burning heat and power used during outages

California's SB 183 already requires CO alarms in homes with gas appliances, a fireplace, or an attached garage, so the gap is compliance and expired sensors. CDC-affiliated authors estimate that home CO detectors return up to $7.20 in benefits for every $1 spent (Ran, Nurmagambetov & Sircar, *Am J Emerg Med* 2018). During the 2003 New York blackout, accidental deaths rose 122% (95% CI 28–287%), and most of the officially attributed deaths were CO poisonings.*

Correction: the “$45–51k per QALY” figure attributed to the CDC is not in that source and has been replaced by the benefit-to-cost ratio. No documented storm CO death in Sacramento was found; the generator deaths from the 2023 storms were in Sonoma County.

5. Walk the blocks before the soil saturates, report large trees over homes and lines, and stay off the roads during wind warnings

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents (private trees); Public Works Urban Forestry via 311 (city trees); SMUD (trees touching lines)	October–November	Volunteer time; private arborist work at owners' cost	Trees through roofs and onto cars, and the outages behind rank 1

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

In January 2023 about 1,500 trees fell in Sacramento (at least 500 City trees and more than 1,000 private), most of them healthy, and Urban Forestry logged about 3,000 requests in three weeks. Report public trees to 311 and trees on lines to SMUD. Nationally, 44% of deaths from wind-thrown trees were in vehicles and 38% outdoors (Schmidlin, *Natural Hazards* 2009), so the cheapest rule is to stay off the roads, and out of rooms under big trees, while a wind warning is up.

Corrections: the City's account blames heavy rain and wind and does not say “saturated soil” (the neighbourhood arborists' explanation). It mentions no on-call contractor crews; the City used its own arborists, helped by Team Rubicon. The SacTree “Save the Elms” volunteer training in Land Park is unverified.

6. Ask the Department of Utilities to confirm backup power at the sumps that drain South Land Park before 15 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City Department of Utilities; a councilmember's office or SLPNA to ask the question	Answer in writing by 15 Nov	A letter; any generator rental is the City's (the $5–20k figure is unsourced)	Street and home flooding if pumps lose SMUD power mid-storm

In the January 2023 storms Department of Utilities crews kept “nearly 100 pump stations working during power outages,” at a cost of about $2.2M for generators, services, and supplies. South Land Park's streets drain by pumping, not gravity, so the question worth asking is narrow: which sumps serve the neighbourhood, and do they have permanent generators or transfer switches?

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the “90+ stations lost power” source returns 404 and has been replaced with the City's own account. Which sumps serve South Land Park, whether they have permanent backup, and the Natomas “all 7 plants” claim are all unverified.

7. Get the status of the levee work beside the neighbourhood in writing, and buy flood insurance by 31 October

UNVERIFIED (LEVEE STATUS) · PARTIALLY CONFIRMED (INSURANCE) · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SAFCA and the USACE Sacramento District (levee); households (insurance)	Levee answer by 1 Nov; insurance bought by 31 Oct for cover from 1 Dec	Premiums paid by households; quote per address	Being caught out by an open work site in flood season; uninsured ruin if a levee fails

SAFCA lists the Sacramento River East Levee project, about 12 miles from downtown to Freeport, as in progress, with USACE construction since 2019 and more cutoff walls and erosion protection planned. It names no reaches or dates. The verifier queried FEMA's flood map at South Land Park points: all are Zone X (one labelled “reduced flood risk due to levee,” another “minimal flood hazard”), so no lender requires insurance. NFIP policies take effect after 30 days.

Corrections: “Preferred Risk” policies no longer exist under Risk Rating 2.0, and the $400–600 premium is unverified. Contract status near Miller Park and the Little Pocket could not be retrieved (USACE and CVFPB pages returned 403). Check that the NFIP is authorised on the day of purchase, because no policies are sold during a lapse. Ranked low because flood insurance protects finances, not lives.

8. Arrange a warm, charging room at Parkside Community Church for outages longer than 24 hours, once it has power of its own

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FRONTLINE · INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Parkside Community Church (UCC), 5700 S. Land Park Dr; SLPNA volunteers	Agreement and power arrangement by 1 Dec	A generator or battery bank is needed first; unpriced	People staying in a cold house, or running a generator indoors, because nowhere nearby is warm

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The church exists at that address and runs a Little Free Pantry out front. Its staff work mostly remotely, and its site mentions no hall, generator, or emergency use, so the ask has to include how the room stays powered. Without power it can only be a paper information point.

Correction: the claim that Belle Cooledge Community Center was used as a warming site in 2008 could not be verified and has been dropped.

9. Ask the SMUD board for a battery tier that MED customers can use, and a standing shutoff suspension on a local storm proclamation

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SMUD Board of Directors	A November board meeting; delivery would follow the peak	~$3–6k per battery at current incentive levels; shutoff suspension ~$0	The structural gap behind rank 1, in future winters

The battery incentive is built for solar owners and excludes MED customers, so a dedicated MED tier is the lasting fix. SMUD's Rule 11 has no disaster clause, but the board suspended non-payment shutoffs by resolution in 2020–21 (verified for the Curtis Park briefing the same day), so the mechanism exists.

Unverified: any existing SMUD rule protecting medical customers from disconnection. This is a fix for next winter; this winter's protection is rank 1.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	County Public Health	SMUD	Resources for Independent Living	Dialysis units	County homeless services & navigators	First Step Communities	Loaves & Fishes	Dept of Utilities	SAFCA / USACE	Urban Forestry (Public Works)	SLPNA & block volunteers	Parkside Church
1. Power-dependent residents: named list, MED, power stations, early dialysis	**A**	**R**	**R**	**R**							**R**	**I**
2. Warning-day offer of a confirmed bed; clearances paused	**I**				**A**	**R**	**R**		**C**		**I**	
3. Check-in roster for older residents living alone	**C**			**C**							**A/R**	**R**
4. CO alarms installed; no generators, grills, or ovens indoors	**C**	**R**	**A/R**								**R**	
5. Tree walk and report; stay off roads in wind		**R**								**R**	**A/R**	
6. Backup power confirmed at neighbourhood sumps		**C**						**A/R**	**I**		**C**	
7. Levee work status in writing; flood insurance by 31 Oct								**C**	**A/R**		**R**	
8. Powered warm room at Parkside Church		**C**									**R**	**A/R**
9. SMUD MED battery tier; standing shutoff suspension	**C**	**A/R**	**C**								**I**	

What the chart shows. **SLPNA and block volunteers carry an R on six of nine rows and are accountable on three**, and the association's current activity could not be verified, so it is the plan's biggest dependency. **The most important action again rests on a data request**: County Public Health has to ask HHS for the named emPOWER file. **Action 2 belongs to the County**, and outside money can only reach motel rooms if the County accepts it.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. Amounts are set at county scale.

FLOOR

$150k ($100k conditional)

TARGET

$215k

CEILING

~$350k

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Whether the County motel programme can take outside money

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

	for extra rooms; partner-motel availability, not cash, is the limit

Floor: motel surge 100 rooms × 10 storm-nights × ~$100 = $100k, plus Loaves & Fishes outreach $50k = $150k. **Target:** $150k + RIL power stations 50 × ~$1,000 = $50k + CO alarms $15k = $215k. **Ceiling:** $215k + 10 more storm-nights ($100k) + 35 more power stations ($35k) = $350k. Verification left the target unchanged. If the motel route is closed, the committable floor is $50k and the target $115k. The $100 room rate and $1,000 unit cost are estimates; no nightly voucher rate is published. A 2 kWh unit runs a 300 W oxygen concentrator for about six hours.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
County motel programme, via First Step Communities or County homeless services (EIN 35-2537631; FY2024 revenue $7.97M)	Action 2: rooms beyond what the County books	$100k	Pre-signed pledge, released on the City's respite trigger	Estimate. FSC runs County respite sites; nothing shows it runs motels. Get written confirmation that extra rooms exist and can be paid for	CONDITIONAL
Sacramento Loaves & Fishes (2025 revenue $12.52M)	Action 2: pre-storm outreach, transport, sleeping bags, tarps	$50k	Rapid general-support grant	0.4% of spend; handed out tarps and tents after the 2023 storms. Confirm it works the camps near South Land Park	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Resources for Independent Living (FY Sept 2025 revenue $1.83M)	Action 1: ~2 kWh power stations for oxygen and device users	$50k	Pre-positioned stock	50 × ~$1,000 (estimate) for 97 oxygen users, many of whom have tanks; screen for need	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Resources for Independent Living	Action 4: CO alarms and generator-safety kits	$15k	Direct grant	Benefit-to-cost up to 7.2:1 (Ran et al. 2018); the “senior meal routes” channel is unverified	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

The funder's one thing: these recipients are the same ones named in the Curtis Park briefing, two miles north, and the money should be one pool, not two. Weight the battery line toward 95822, which has 3.4 times Curtis Park's device users. And buy pre-committed headroom on the

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tool that works rather than a new programme: the County already says motels beat warming centres, and that staffing and room supply, not willingness, are its limits. Sign the pledge before the first atmospheric river. Nothing in Sacramento is pre-arranged today; the regional community foundation shows no standing disaster fund.

DO NOT DO THIS — CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Sweep the riverside and Miller Park camps before storms

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN

Two lenses proposed it. A public comment to the City Council for 10 January 2023 alleges that pre-storm sweeps took “storm survival gear… vehicles, sleeping bags, clothing”, and asked the City to stop sweeps during storms. That is an allegation, and no City response was found. But confiscation in sweeps is documented in Sacramento (July 2023, a man lost his tent and the clothes he could not carry), and a councilmember criticised Caltrans for removing tents on W Street with no relocation plan. The County's own evidence explains why it matters: motels work because people can bring their belongings, and a sweep strips exactly the gear that keeps someone alive outdoors in a storm.

Instead: pause clearances while a warning is active, and make the pre-storm contact a voluntary offer of a confirmed bed, with belongings (action 2).

Buy parametric insurance on Sacramento Executive Airport wind or rain

CONTRAINDICATED AS INSURANCE

The proposed trigger (gusts of 55 mph or more, or 2.5 inches of rain in a day, at KSAC) fired in about four of the last eight seasons, so it is not a tail event and would be priced like an annual payment. The station's 2009–2013 gust record contains impossible values of 100–158 kt, so it would need a quality-controlled source and a fallback station. One airport gauge does not measure tree-fall outages in South Land Park: on 24 October 2021, 5.41 inches of rain fell with only a 36 kt gust. No off-the-shelf product was found.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: if a donor wants a trigger, write it as a contingent grant paid into the action 2 pool when the City's respite criteria activate. That trigger already exists and fires on the forecast, before the damage.

Also avoid (lens advice, consistent with verified evidence): leading with levee evacuation messages and sandbag giveaways in a neighbourhood where the recorded deaths came from trees; warming centres opened on a temperature trigger alone; telling people to “get a generator”; and plans that assume everyone has a car or a working phone. Do not rely on the state's disaster utility protections for electricity either: they apply to CPUC-regulated utilities after a Governor's proclamation, which covers PG&E gas here but not SMUD (verified for the Curtis Park briefing). Only the camp point and the protections point were verified for this report.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1850–1862	Floods in 1850, 1852, and 1861–62; the first levee runs from Sutterville to I Street along South Land Park's northern edge	~4,000 dead across the West in 1862; no city count found	Downtown streets raised about 10 ft over ~15 years (lens)
1918	City buys William Land Park's land, then a “flood spill” and drainage area	n/a	The park and the neighbourhoods south of it built on old floodplain (lens)
Feb 1986	I Street gauge crests at 30.6–30.7 ft, the highest since records began in 1912; city levees hold	13–14 dead statewide; 50,000 evacuated	SAFCA formed in 1989; more than $2B spent since; Auburn Dam never built
Jan 1997	City spared; nearby levees break	Regional deaths (figure not re-verified)	Folsom spillway project, finished 2017
2003	Seepage cutoff walls on the east levee in the Pocket and Little Pocket	n/a	Levee works continue under USACE from 2019 (lens)

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2015–16	Strong El Niño; the Sacramento Weir stayed shut until January 2017	None found	Showed that a forecast El Niño is not a forecast flood
Dec 2022 – Jan 2023	Atmospheric rivers in a La Niña winter; 8 Jan windstorm	2 unhoused people killed by trees on tents (not in South Land Park); ~599,000 SMUD customer outages; South Land Park homes dark 3+ days; Miller Park Safe Ground halted	City respite criteria widened in 2023; Safe Ground reopened in trailers by 2026

The recurrence nobody has noticed: for 160 years South Land Park's protection has been measured in levee feet, from the 1850 Sutterville levee to today's cutoff walls. In the worst storm series on record here the river held, and the harm came from healthy trees on soaked ground, failed power, and camps pushed against the water. That hazard has no owning agency and no budget line, and it comes back every few winters whatever the ENSO phase. Also: do not stand down if this El Niño winter starts dry. 2015–16 was quiet, and January 2017 flooded.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

UNRESOLVED

- **Sweep camps before storms** (Emergency manager, Historian) versus **pause clearances** (Skeptic). Verification supports the Skeptic, and the sweep is listed as contraindicated.
- **The levee is the risk to prepare for** (Historian, Emergency manager) versus **trees and outages are what kill here** (Skeptic, Frontline, Public health). The report ranks trees and outages higher and keeps the levee as a cheap written check plus insurance.
- **Plan for El Niño** versus **El Niño barely moves Sacramento's odds**. The report acts on each forecast storm.
- **Batteries through SMUD** (Economist) versus **through a nonprofit** (Philanthropist). Both survive: the nonprofit can move this winter, and a SMUD tier is the lasting fix.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

No lens established **which languages are spoken** in ZIP 95822, and the poorer parts of the ZIP south and east of South Land Park may need materials beyond English and Spanish. Check the ACS language tables before printing anything. No lens looked at **care homes and assisted-living residences**, or at **access to hospitals** if Sutterville Rd, Freeport Blvd, and Riverside Blvd are blocked by trees at the same time. Nobody

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costed the **compound case** of a levee seepage emergency during a multi-day outage, when the sumps and the warning systems both depend on generator power.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people, and are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named “South Land Park, Sacramento”. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Sacramento County, CA, *inferred* rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Most local statistics are for ZIP/ZCTA 95822 (46,569 people), which covers South Land Park *plus* Hollywood Park, Golf Course Terrace, and the Freeport corridor, all poorer than South Land Park. A non-census estimate puts South Land Park itself at about 14,400 people.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted: two lenses converged on pre-storm camp sweeps, which verification moved to contraindicated. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked 13 recommendations and the funding placements on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they are already implemented. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, the FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer, the Census geocoder, and the Iowa Environmental Mesonet record for KSAC directly. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted earlier the same day (8 October 2026) by driving the inventory's map interface in a browser for the Elmwood briefing; the US filter returns 19 entries, none covering power-dependent residents, check-in rosters, CO alarms, tree reporting, camp outreach, or pump backup. It was not re-driven for this location. Actions are tagged “none found” on that basis.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (medical equipment in an outage, warming shelter, and CO alarms) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total. Retail and lens cost estimates are labelled as such. No local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. **The shared web-search quota ran out during verification**, so four of five verifiers worked by fetching known primary pages, and saccounty.gov, cityofsacramento.gov, USACE, and CVFPB pages returned 404 or 403. As a result the levee contract status, the sumps serving the neighbourhood, SLPNA's activity, encampments near South Land Park, and the hypothermia figures were not verified here. No storm death inside South Land Park was found; the death record is county-wide.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. HHS emPOWER REST service (queried 8 Oct 2026) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 95822 (verified) · SMUD Medical Equipment Discount (verified) · SMUD battery incentive (verified) · PG&E DDAR fact sheet (verified, Curtis Park run) · Lurie et al. 2015 (verified; companion paper Kelman et al. 2015 reports the outcomes) · ASPR TRACIE summary of Lurie et al. (verified, Curtis Park run) · Anderson & Bell 2012 (verified) · County respite recap (verified via index; page now 404) · Miller Park Safe Ground reopens (verified) · County Coroner, January 2023 deaths (verified) · City respite criteria (verified, Curtis Park run) · Council public comment, 10 Jan 2023 (allegation) · Midtown sweep, July 2023 (verified) · Caltrans W Street removals (verified) · Sacramento Manor (search snapshot) · Parkside Community Church (verified) · Ran et al. 2018, CO detector economics (verified) · Sonoma generator CO deaths (lens) · Schmidlin 2009 (verified, Curtis Park run) · City tree damage, Jan 2023 (verified) · City storm response, pump stations (verified) · SAFCA, Sacramento River East Levee (verified) · FEMA NFHL flood

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zones (queried) · Iowa Environmental Mesonet, KSAC daily record (queried) · SMUD Rule 11 (verified, Curtis Park run) · First Step Communities, IRS filings (verified) · Sacramento Loaves & Fishes, IRS filings (verified) · Resources for Independent Living, IRS filings (verified) · Sacramento Region Community Foundation (verified) · SMUD storm damage, TDWorld (lens) · South Land Park outages, ABC10 (lens) · I Street gauge, CNRFC (lens) · SAFCA (lens) · Pocket cutoff walls, CEQA (lens) · Sacramento Weir, 2017 (lens) · Sutterville levee marker (lens) · Great Flood of 1862 (lens, not re-verified)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory (US)

Generated 8 October 2026 for South Land Park, Sacramento. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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